

MS Flight to be free-to-play

A new version of Microsoft's Flight Simulator series will be released this spring for PC

Note crosses 1 million in sales

Samsung Galaxy Note crosses 1 million units in sale in 2 months

Sound Blaster Tactic Sigma

Sonic boom, literally

This headset is part of Creative's Sound Blaster Tactic series of gaming headsets. They feature such knick-knacks as THX ProStudio technology, a detachable microphone, flat and long cable wires (tangle-free), in-line volume control and the option to use the headset via USB or analog jacks. The build quality is decent but even though it has a steel band inserted into the headband, the plastic on the cups feels a bit flimsy. The cushioning does what it is meant to do and is quite soft. The headset fits snugly over the head, the movable cups and adjustable headband ensure this. However, it can be a bit too snug at times as the pads can be a little too small for some people.



The headset is best used in USB mode. Analog mode works but the volume levels can be a bit too low, even with a decent sound card. USB mode provides a significant boost in volume and the THX ProStudio Desktop software provides you with a lot of control over your audio. The software fea-

tures something called a "crystaliser" for improving voice quality, but it introduces too much noise and can be a bit irritating. In fact, the audio sounds best when all enhancements, except the equaliser of course, are turned off.

Performance-wise the headset is strictly decent. Above average for music but the bass is muddy and there is no punch. Primarily geared to being a gaming headset, it works quite well in that regard. Lack of bass aside, the stereo separation is good and it was easy for us to figure out the location of gunshots in Crysis 2 and COD.

All in all a decent headset and at ₹4,000, it is a good buy for your PC. For better music quality and bass, best look elsewhere.

Anirudh Regidi

Specifications

Drivers: 50mm Neodymium magnet driven, **Impedance:** 32ohms, **Frequency response:** 20Hz~20kHz, Circumaural design, **Dual mode:** USB/Analog, Detachable microphone bundled

Contact

Creative
Email: vinayendra.singh@compugaindia.com
Website: in.creative.com
Price: ₹4,000

6.5/10

Features	7.0
Performance.....	6.5
Build Quality	6.5
Value for Money	7.0

Viewsonic Pro8400 projector

Wins where most other projectors have lost

Specifications

Type: DLP projector;
Video Resolution: Full HD resolution; **Contrast Ratio:** 3000:1; **Brightness:** 4000 ANSI lumens; **HDMI in:** 2 HDMI; **Weight:** 3.86kg

Contact

Viewsonic India
Web site: www.ap.viewsonic.com/in/
Price: ₹1,47,000

8.0/10

Features	8.0
Performance.....	8.5
Build Quality	7.5
Value for Money	8.0

Straight out of the box, the Pro8400 looks the part - a full-fledged 'I mean business' HD projector. You have two HDMI inputs to connect multiple devices to the projector. The Pro8400 has built-in speakers, it can spit out audio as well - something projectors are lacking off late.

We had placed the projector about 3 feet from the wall, and got about 80-inches big display. To utilize the two HDMI inputs, we hooked up the TataSky HD set top box and a WD Live HD media player to the Pro8400 simultaneously. First off, we checked the SD content performance. It handled the low resolutions quite well even when blown up to this

size. Keeping the sharpness setting around 10 is perfect for SD content. We then switched to HD content, and to Star Movies HD and ESPN HD on TataSky. The colour reproduction was good, quite visible by the uniformity of the green grass. However, when the camera panned quickly, the crowd would look like jagged lines momentarily. Movies are where the depth of the blacks was of paramount importance, and this one did as well as the LG AF115 we had reviewed earlier. The whites tend to be overbearingly bright,

and that can be a little stressful on the eyes.

We were deeply impressed by the brightness levels offered by this projector. So much so that this is the first projector to have won the battle against daylight streaming in through the windows! Brightness and contrast levels were set just above 50 per cent.

Bright enough to actually work in any room at any time of the day, the Pro8400 is meant for someone who would like a projector at home, but doesn't really have a dedicated, darkened room for a home theater.

The image reproduction is delightful, and handles SD content better than most.

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